

Nikhil Rao

CONTACT

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EMPLOYMENT	Postdoctoral Fellow , National Bureau of Economic Research	2025–Present
EDUCATION	Ph.D., Economics , University of Michigan	2025
	M.A., Economics , University of Michigan	2021
	B.A., Economics & Mathematics , University of Massachusetts Amherst	2015
FIELDS	Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics	
WORKING PAPERS	“Measuring Discrimination using Natural Experiments” , with James Reeves. “Parental Resources and College Major Choice” , with Zsigmond Pálvölgyi & Tyler Radler.	
IN PROGRESS	“The Socioeconomic Consequences of Misdemeanor Conviction” , with James Reeves. “Using Network Data to Measure Social Returns and Improve Targeting of Crime-Reduction Interventions” , with Ashley Craig, Sara Heller, and Kenneth Hofmeister. “Peer Socioeconomic Mismatch and Student Achievement” , with Micah Y. Baum. “Examining Interventions to Improve Outcomes of Justice-involved Individuals” , with James Reeves.	
PUBLICATIONS	“Inflation Expectations and Nonlinearities in the Phillips Curve” , with Alexander Doser, Ricardo Nunes and Viacheslav Sheremirov. <i>Journal of Applied Econometrics</i> 38:4 (2023), 453–471. “Sectoral inflation and the Phillips curve: What has changed since the Great Recession?” , with Maria Jose Luengo-Prado and Viacheslav Sheremirov. <i>Economics Letters</i> 172 (2018), 63–68.	
EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS	2026 (including upcoming) George Washington University Linnaeus University Opportunity Insights Conference on Economic Mobility Georgetown University CJARS 10-Year Anniversary Conference NBER SI (Law & Economics, Crime) Policy Impacts Annual Conference Federal Reserve Bank of Boston	Washington, DC Växjö, Sweden Cambridge, MA Washington, DC Ann Arbor, MI Cambridge, MA Cambridge, MA Boston, MA
	2025 Tufts University Brownbag Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars University of Colorado	Medford, MA Philadelphia, PA Denver, CO
	2024 Southern Economic Association Meeting Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management Fall Conference Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime Western Economic Association Conference	Washington, DC National Harbor, MD Zurich, Switzerland Seattle, WA

2019

Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting

Lansing, MI

**AWARDS &
FELLOWSHIPS**

Policy Impacts Early Career Scholars Grant	2026
Department of Economics Fellowship	2025
Rackham One Term Dissertation Fellowship	2024
Rackham Conference Travel Grant	2024 (x2)
Department of Economics Conference Travel Grant	2019; 2024 (x2)
Poverty Solutions One Term Fellowship	2023
Department of Economics Research Grant	2022; 2023
Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship	2018–2019

TEACHING**University of Michigan**

Economics of the Population (ECON 466)	Fall 2020
Introductory Macroeconomics (ECON 102)	Winter 2020
Introductory Microeconomics (ECON 101)	Fall 2019

**RESEARCH
EXPERIENCE &
EMPLOYMENT****University of Michigan**

Graduate Research Assistant to Ashley Craig & Sara Heller	2020–2024
Summer Research Assistant to Ana Reynoso	2020
Summer Research Assistant to Lauren Falcao Bergquist	2019

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston

Senior Research Assistant, Jenny Tang & Viacheslav Sheremirov	2015–2018
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SERVICE

Referee: <i>American Law and Economics Review</i> , <i>Journal of Human Resources</i> , <i>Journal of Policy Analysis and Management</i> , <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>	
Graduate Program Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2021–2022
Admissions Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2020–2021
Social Chair, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2019–2020

OTHER

Analytics and Programming: Stata, R, Matlab and $\text{\LaTeX}$
Clearance: U.S. Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status
Citizenship: USA

REFERENCES**Sara Heller**

Associate Professor
 Department of Economics
 University of Michigan
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Basit Zafar

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 Department of Economics
 University of Michigan
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Michael Mueller-Smith

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Ashley Craig

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 Research School of Economics
 Australian National University
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